The Least Developed Countries

The **Least Developed Countries** is a list of countries that, according to the United Nations, exhibit the lowest indicators of socioeconomic development, with the lowest Human Development Index ratings of all countries in the world. A country is classified among the Least Developed Countries if it meets three criteria.

- Poverty – adjustable criterion based on GNI per capita averaged over three years. As of 2018 a country must have GNI per capita less than US$1,025 to be included on the list, and over $1,230 to graduate from it.

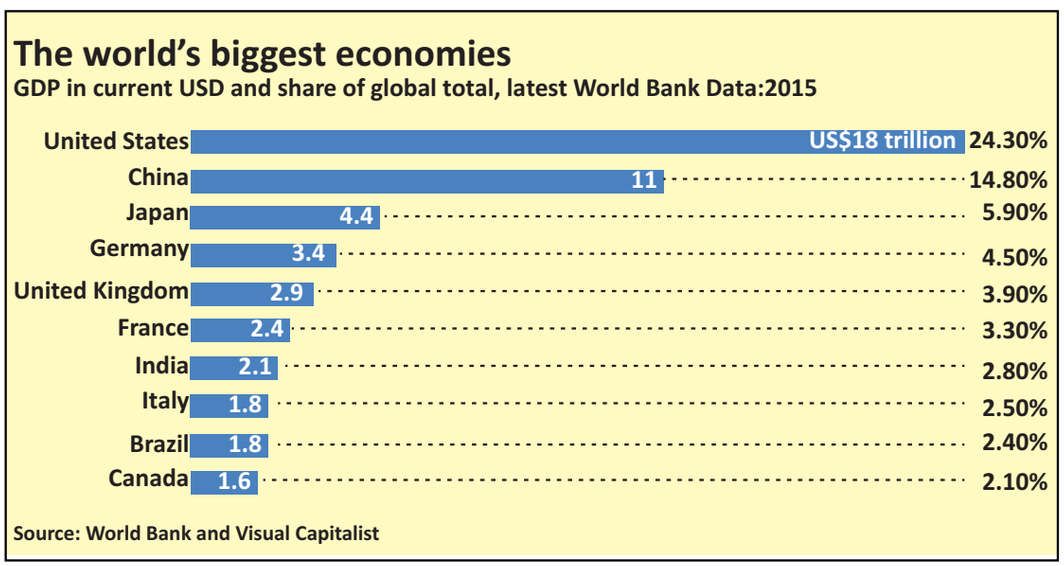
- Human resource weakness (based on indicators of nutrition, health, education and adult literacy).

- Economic vulnerability (based on instability of agricultural production, instability of exports of goods and services, economic importance of non-traditional activities, merchandise export concentration, handicap of economic smallness, and the percentage of population displaced by natural disasters).

The world's 10 biggest economies in 2015

The economy of the **United States** is the largest in the world. At **$18** trillion, it represents a quarter share of the global economy (24.3%), according to the latest World Bank figures.

China follows, with **$11** trillion, or 14.8% of the world economy. Japan is in third place with an economy of **$4.4** trillion, which represents almost 6% of the world economy. European countries take the next three places on the list: **Germany** in fourth position, with a $**3.3** trillion economy; the **United Kingdom** in fifth wit**h $2.9** trillion; and **France** in sixth with **$2.4** trillion. **India** is in seventh place with **$2.1** trillion, and **Italy** in eighth with an economy of over **$1.8** trillion. Ninth place goes to **Brazil**, with an almost **$1.8** trillion economy. And in 10th is **Canada**, with an economy of over **$1.6** trillion. The economy of the United States is larger than the combined economies of numbers three to 10 on the list.



TN_GOVT_XII_Geography_chapter 04.indd 78 12/6/2022 6:03:09 PM